

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In BackTalk, we converse with Alienware's Anand Subramanya and Alienware's plans in India. Next, in DGT explore what the team's been watching and some cool gadgets from around the world

Source: India Times



Now you can find branded ketchup on Mars

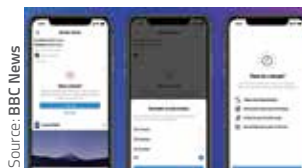
On Monday, Heinz debuted the Heinz Tomato Ketchup Marz Edition, which is created from tomatoes cultivated in a harsh Mars-like environment. Heinz worked with a 14-person astrobiology team at Florida Tech's Aldrin Space Institute for nine months to cultivate these tomatoes. They mimicked the soil, temperature, and water conditions observed on Mars. <https://dgit.in/marssauce>

WHAT'S NEW

Instagram announces "Take a Break" for teens

After being blamed for increased anxiety among teens through internal research, Instagram has released new limiting features where parents can monitor the time spent by their children on the app. This move came just a day before Instagram CEO Adam Mosseri was scheduled to testify before a committee of US Senators looking into online safety.

Since Instagram directly impacts the mental health of its young users, a number of features such as account privacy for minors, redirection towards different types of posts in case users get stuck on a particular hashtag etc have



Source: BBC News

already been implemented. Instagram also said that in March 2022, it would release

a new tool for parents that will allow them to track how much time their children spend on Instagram and set time limits for the app. Teens will also be able to opt into a system that will notify their parents if they make a report against an Instagram user.

<https://dgit.in/takeabreak>

Google shuts down cybercrime affecting around 1 million devices

Google announced that it has taken steps to shut down a network of nearly one million hijacked electronic devices used to commit online crimes around the world, as well as suing the alleged hackers based in Russia. The botnet, named Glupteba, was first noticed in 2011, masquerading as free downloadable soft-



Source: Arklafex

ware, movies or videos. The so-called botnet of infected devices, which was also used to secretly mine Bitcoin, has been shut off from those

operating it on the Internet, at least for the time being.

Google said the network, which comprises around one million Windows-using machines around the world, has targeted victims from the United States, India, Brazil, and Southeast Asia for crimes such as stealing users' credentials.

<https://dgit.in/googlevscime>



Source: The Verge

5G may have side effects, but it's not what you think

Planes rely on radio altimeters to determine how high above the ground they are in order to land safely when pilots can't see, and the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) has now instructed many of them not to do so at particular airports due to 5G interference. <https://dgit.in/5gap>



Source: The Indian Eagle

Your face might become your boarding pass

Airports in the United States are now using biometrics for processes such as checking-in and clearing customs. Many airports, airlines, IT businesses, and government agencies continue to invest in biometric breakthroughs during the travel ban. <https://dgit.in/facepass>



Source: CNN News

Can we capture the end of civilization?

A team of scientists is constructing a large, unbreakable box that will store scientific data and provide future civilizations with insight into how humanity collapsed. Earth's Black Box is a massive steel monolith that will be built in a remote Tasmanian area. <https://dgit.in/civend>